"Internship recruitment made simple"

Description

InternFirst is reshaping how students, universities, and employers connect in the internship world. We focus exclusively on early-talent recruitment, ensuring every opportunity is verified and legitimate. Students get access to real internships, no spam, no outdated listings, and no broken links to external sites. Universities receive the KPI insights they've been missing, giving them clearer visibility into student engagement and outcomes. Employers gain a simpler, more efficient way to reach motivated student talent. Our closed ecosystem keeps every application and interview on platform, making the entire process more transparent and easier to track. We're committed to raising the standard of trust and authenticity in internship recruitment. With streamlined profiles, direct messaging, and clean analytics, we're making career-building more accessible for everyone involved. Whether you're exploring your first internship or hiring your next great intern, InternFirst makes the process simple, data-driven, and reliable. We're here to bridge the gap between opportunity and early talent, one verified internship at a time. Let's build the future of internships *together*.

Design

Navy Blue (used in the cap + "Intern")

- HEX: #1A2D49

Green (used in the arrow + tassel)

- HEX: #9FC63C

Light Grey (used in "First")

- HEX: #DFE0E1

(soft off-white) background

- HEX: #F8F9FC

Font

- Inter (Google Fonts) – Clean, modern, readable

Must Follow these accessibility Laws

- https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG21/

Student Experience Overview

i. Global Student UI Elements (Persistent Across All Student Pages)

- **Top Navigation Bar**

        - Tabs:
            - Home
            - Job Portal
            - School-Affiliated Job Portal
            - Messages
            - Career Resources
            - Profile
            - Settings
        - **InternFirst logo** in top-left corner
            - Blue border around logo
            - Logo links back to **Home**
- **Authentication State**
    - Only accessible after **.edu email verification**
- **Design Consistency**
    - Clean, modern interface
    - Student-first layout (calendar, networking, recruiting visibility)

1. Student Login / Signup Page (.EDU Gated)

Goal

- Ensure only verified students can access the platform

Key Features

- **Login**
    - Email + password
- **Signup**
    - Requires **.edu email address**
    - Email verification flow (magic link or code)
- **Validation**
    - Non-.edu emails blocked with clear error messaging
    - Prevent duplicate accounts

Post-Signup Behavior

- First-time users routed to **home screen**
- Optional onboarding prompts (profile completion nudges)

2. Home Screen (Student Dashboard)

Goal

- Central hub for a student's recruiting, events, and deadlines

<u>Layout Structure</u>

Left Sidebar

- **Affiliated School Events**
    - Career fairs
    - Info sessions
    - Networking events

- **Local Employer Events**
    - Based on location (e.g., Raleigh)
    - Meetups, info nights, recruiting events

Center (Primary Content Area)

- **Applied Jobs Overview (Above Calendar)**
    - Snapshot of all roles the student has applied to
    - Displays current application status using an **in-platform ATS**
        - Examples:
            - Application Submitted
            - Under Review
            - Interview Requested
            - Interview Scheduled
            - Offer Extended
            - Rejected / Closed
    - Visual progress indicators (status tags or progress bars)
    - Click-through capability to:
        - View job details
        - See recruiter messages
        - Access interview scheduling (if applicable)
- **Interactive Calendar**
    - Scheduled interviews
    - Career events the student is attending
    - Application deadlines
        - Automatically added when an application is started
    - RSVP Functionality for Events
        - Students can RSVP directly to:
            - Career fairs
            - Employer info sessions
            - Club-hosted events
    - RSVP status updates:
        - “Attending”
        - “Interested”
        - “Not Attending”
    - RSVP’d events automatically:
        - Appear on calendar
        - Trigger reminders
    - Event detail page includes:
        - Description
        - Date/time/location
        - Hosting organization
        - Attending employers (if career fair)
        - RSVP button (if applicable)
- **Visual Indicators**

    - Color-coded event types
    - Upcoming deadlines highlighted

Right Sidebar

- **Industry News Feed**
    - Curated news based on:
        - Major / field of study (Business, Biology, Engineering, etc.)
    - Articles, headlines, and trends relevant to early talent

Survey Banner

- Where it appears
    - A persistent banner at the top of the screen
    - Below the main navigation bar
    - *ONLY ON THE STUDENT HOME PAGE*
- Banner Behavior
    - Displays:
        - Survey title
        - Short description
        - "Complete Survey" button
        - Progress bar
- Cannot be dismissed if:
    - Marked as "Required" by university
- Banner remains visible until:
    - Survey is submitted
    - Survey expires (if optional)
- User Experience Flow
    - Student logs in
    - Banner appears
    - Clicking opens:
        - Modal overlay OR
        - Dedicated survey page
    - Upon submission
        - Confirmation message
        - Banner disappears

3. Job Portal (General InternFirst Job Board)

Goal

- Enable discovery and application to internships and early-career roles

<u>Layout (LinkedIn-Style Split View)</u>

Left Panel

- **Scrollable Job Listings**
    - Company name
    - Role title
    - Location (or remote)

    - Internship
- **Search Bar**
    - Keyword search (role, company, skill)
- **Filters**
    - Location
    - Industry
    - Paid vs unpaid
    - Internship length
    - Remote / hybrid / in-person

Right Panel

- **Selected Job View**
    - Full job description
    - Company overview
    - Required / preferred skills
    - Application deadline
- **Apply Flow**
    - In-platform application (no external redirects)

4. School-Affiliated Job Portal

Goal

- Create a university-branded recruiting environment

Key Differences from General Job Portal

- **Top-left Branding**
    - InternFirst logo replaced with **school logo**
        - Example: NC State logo for NCSU students
- **Content Scope**
    - Jobs approved or affiliated with the student's school
    - University-specific employer partnerships
- **Same UX Pattern**
    - Job list on left
    - Job details on right
    - Search and filters included

5. Messaging

Goal

- Enable direct networking and communication

Layout

- **Left Panel**
    - Conversation list
        - Recruiters
        - Employers
        - Alumni
        - Peers

- **Right Panel**
    - Chat window
        - iMessage / Teams-style interface
        - Real-time messaging
- **Use Cases**
    - Interview coordination
    - Networking conversations
    - Career advice and referrals

6. Career Resources

Goal

- Support career readiness at different commitment levels

Free Section

- Resume writing guides
- Interview tips
- Career development articles
- Blogs and educational content
- If part of an affiliated university:
    - Schedule career center appointments
        - Appointment type
        - Available time slot (like Calendly)
    - Appoints automatically:
        - Appear on student calendar
        - Appear on university CRM calendar
        - Notify assigned advisor

Paid Section

- **1:1 Resume Reviews**
- **1:1 Career Coaching**
- **1:1 Interview Prep**
- Clear separation between free and paid offerings
- Simple upgrade / booking flow

7. Student Profile

Goal

- Act as a dynamic, recruiter-facing student profile

Profile Components

- Profile photo
- **10–30 second "Elevator Pitch" video**
- Resume upload (PDF)
- Skills (dropdown-based + custom)
- Experiences
    - Internships
    - Projects

        - Campus involvement
    - Academic info
        - Major
        - School
    - Optional attributes
        - Greek life
        - Clubs / organizations

Visibility

- Profile used for:
    - Applications
    - Recruiter discovery + networking

8. Settings

Goal

- Allow students to manage preferences and privacy

Settings Options

- Account details
- Email notifications
- Messaging preferences
- Privacy controls
- Password & security
- Subscription management (if using paid resources)

Employer Experience Overview

i. Global Employer UI Elements (Persistent Across All Employer Pages)

- **Top Navigation Bar**
    - Tabs:
        - Home
        - Post a Job
        - Posted Jobs
        - CRM
        - Messages
        - Account
        - Settings
- **Branding**
    - InternFirst logo in top-left corner with blue border
    - Logo links back to Employer Home
- **User Roles**
    - Multiple users per company
    - Each user has:
        - Their own login (email + password)
        - Their own messages and scheduled interviews
- **Shared Company Data**

        - Job postings
        - Applicants
        - Company-wide events

1. Employer Signup & Login

<u>Signup Flow</u>

Account Creation

- Email + password required
- Ability to **add additional users** after signup
    - Each user has:
        - Separate email
        - Separate password
        - Role-based access

Verification Steps

- **Email Verification**
    - Required to activate account
- **Company Verification**
    - Input **Federal EIN**
    - System checks if company is a registered business
    - Verification window: **1–2 business days**
    - Status shown in account dashboard (Pending / Verified)

Permissions

- Account access limited until company verification is approved
- Posting jobs may be restricted or capped during verification

Login

- Standard email + password login
- Redirects to Employer Home

2. Employer Home Dashboard

Goal

- Central hub for scheduling, events, and recruiting activity

Core Layout

- **Primary Focus: Calendar View**

Calendar

- **Individual Interviews**
    - Shows interviews scheduled by the logged-in user
- **Shared Company Events**
    - Career fairs
    - Info sessions
    - Recruiting events
- All users see the **same company-wide events**
- Calendar syncs with:
    - Interview scheduling
    - Event registrations

    - Job posting timelines

3. Post a Job

Goal

- Allow flexible job posting options for employers of all sizes

Posting Options

- **Pay Per Post**
    - One-time fee per listing based off how many *potential* applicants you want
- **Budget Posting**
    - Note on screen after selecting
        - If you think your job will fall short of the occupation group conversion rate, choose PPA.
        - If you think your job will outperform the occupation group conversion rate, choose PPC
    - PPC/PPA-style model
    - Employer sets a budget
    - Spend optimized based on performance
- **Organic (Free)**
    - Limited visibility
    - Ideal for early-stage or small employers

Job Creation Flow

- Occupation group
- Industry
- Job title
- Location / remote
- Job description
- Required / preferred skills
- Application deadline
- Posting type selection

4. Posted Jobs (Job Management & Analytics)

Goal

- Provide visibility into performance and candidate quality

<u>Layout (Split View)</u>

Left Panel

- List of all posted jobs
    - Status (Active, Paused, Closed)
    - Posting type (Paid, Budget, Organic)

Right Panel (Selected Job View)

Performance Metrics

- Total views
- Click-through rate
- Number of “Apply” clicks
- Completed applications

Candidate Pipeline

- Applicants listed **in ranked order**
    - Ordered by InternFirst's matching algorithm
    - Based on skills, major, experience, and job fit
- Quick actions:
    - View profile
    - Message candidate
    - Move to interview

5. Employer CRM Overview

Goal

- Provide an internal recruiting workflow system for companies hiring interns
- Think:
    - Lightweight Greenhouse
    - Simplified Lever
    - Jira-style task flow
    - ATS + team workflow combined

Kanban Board Layout (Jira-style)

- Columns:
    - New applicants
    - Under Review
    - Screening
    - Interview Round 1
    - Interview Round (2,3...)
    - Offer
    - Hired
    - Rejected
- Features
    - Drag-and-drop candidates between stages
    - Assign candidate owner (Recruiter A, Hiring Manager B)
    - Add internal notes (not visible to applicants)

Task Board

- Each job posting can have tasks like:
    - "Review 20 applicants"
    - "Schedule interviews"
    - "Send offer letter"
    - "Attend career fair"
- Assign to specific team member
- Due dates
- Status:
    - To Do
    - In Progress
    - Completed

Interview Delegation

- Inside candidate view
    - Assign interviewer
    - Schedule interview
    - Add calendar invite
    - Share resume + profile
    - Leave interview feedback
- Calendar syncs with:
    - Employer home dashboard

Student Outreach Management

- CRM should include:
    - Bulk message capability
    - Talent pool tagging
        - “Engineering prospects”
        - “Career fair leads”
    - Track:
        - Messages sent
        - Responses received
        - Conversion to application

Internal Notes & Collaboration

- Each candidate profile should allow:
    - Internal comments
    - @mention team members

6. Messages

Goal

- Enable direct, efficient recruiter communication

Key Characteristics

- **User-specific inbox**
    - Messages are tied to the individual employer user
    - No shared company inbox
- **Chat Interface**
    - iMessage / Teams-style layout
    - Conversations on the left
    - Active chat on the right

Use Cases

- Candidate outreach
- Interview coordination
- Networking conversations

7. Account

Goal

- Manage recruiter and company profile information

Recruiter Profile

- Name

- Title
- Contact info
- Profile visibility to students

Company Profile

- Company name
- Logo
- Description
- Industry
- Location(s)

Permissions

- **Primary account creator**
    - Full access to company profile edits
    - User management (add/remove employees)

8. Settings

Goal

- Control access, security, and preferences

Settings Options

- User roles & permissions
- Password & security
- Notification preferences
- Billing & payment methods
- Verification status
- Posting defaults

University / Career Center Experience Overview

Global University UI Elements (Persistent Across All University Pages)

- **Institutional Branding**
    - School logo displayed in the **top-left corner** (replacing InternFirst logo)
    - Platform color scheme adapts to the **school's official colors**
- **User-Based Access**
    - Multiple users per institution
    - Role-based permissions depending on user type
- **Scope of Data**
    - All analytics and content tied to students using the school's **.edu domain**

1. University Account Provisioning & Login

Account Setup (InternFirst-Initiated)

- Upon signing a contract, InternFirst provides:
    - **Primary account credentials**
        - Typically, the **Director of Employer Relations** or Career Center lead
        - Email + password supplied securely
- Primary user logs in and completes initial setup

User Management

- Primary user can:
  - Add individual users with unique emails and passwords
  - Assign permission levels
- Examples of users:
  - Career center staff
  - Department admins
  - Affiliated clubs (sales club, engineering club, etc.)

Login

- Email + password login
- Branded university dashboard loads on entry

2. Navigation Structure

Top Navigation Tabs

- KPI Dashboard
- Posted Jobs
- Calendar
- Surveys
- CRM
- Messages
- Account
- Settings

3. KPI Dashboard

Goal

- Provide actionable insights into student internship outcomes and engagement

Data Tracked (School-Level, Aggregated)

- Internship placement locations
- Time-to-interview rate
- Acceptance rate
- Average number of applications submitted per student
- Application-to-interview conversion
- Employer engagement metrics
- Industry distribution of internships
- Career fair attendance rates
- Event RSVP-to-attendance conversion
- Student engagement by event type
- Survey response rate
- And more

Scope

- Metrics only include:
  - Students logged in with the school's **.edu email**
- Data can be filtered by:
  - Major

        - Graduation year
        - College or department (if applicable)

4. Posted Jobs (School-Affiliated Job Board Management)

Goal

- Centralize and manage all school-affiliated internship postings

Job Sources

- Internships from:
    - School-affiliated programs
    - Approved employers
    - Affiliated clubs and organizations
- **External Integration Example**
    - For NC State:
        - **ePACK integration**
        - All internship postings are automatically imported into InternFirst
        - These postings appear in the **Student School-Affiliated Job Portal**

Job Management Features

- View all active and past postings
- Approve, edit, or remove postings (based on permissions)
- Visibility controls for student access

5. Calendar (Events Management)

Goal

- Centralize all career-related events for students

Event Types

- Career fairs
- Employer info sessions
- Networking events
- Club-hosted career events
    - Only shows for students who say they are enrolled in the club

Permissions

- Career center admins:
    - Upload and manage all events
- Affiliated clubs:
    - Upload and manage **their own events only**
- Events automatically surface on:
    - Student Home dashboard
    - Student calendars (when relevant)

RSVP Tracking

- Universities can view:
    - Total RSVPs per event
    - Breakdown by major / graduation year
- Live attendee list (student names + profile links)

- Option to print out QR code for students to scan to “check in” when they get to career fair

6. Surveys Tab
Goal
- Allow universities to create and distribute surveys to students using their .edu login.

Capabilities
- Create survey
  - Title
  - Description
  - Questions (multiple choice, short answer, rating scale, etc.)
  - Required / optional toggle
- Target audience filters:
  - All students
  - By major
  - By graduation year
  - By internship status
- Schedule:
  - Immediate distribution
  - Future date
  - Expiration date
- Response Tracking
  - Completion rate
  - Response analytics
  - Exportable results (CSV)
  - Anonymous or identifiable toggle

7. University CRM Overview
Goal
- Provide internal workflow and employer relationship management for career centers and affiliated departments
  - Appointment management
  - Student case tracking
  - Internal task coordination
  - Career center workflow
- Think:
  - Simple advising CRM
  - Case management system
  - Appointment tracking dashboard

Student Case Management
- Search by:
  - Name
  - Major

    - Graduation Month/Year
    - Internship status
- Click student > opens profile summary:
    - Internship applications
    - Interview status
    - Survey completion
    - Event attendance
    - Career center appointments

Appointment Management

- Calendar view (Inside CRM or Linked to Calendar Tab)
- Advisors can
    - See upcoming appointments
    - View student details before meeting
    - Add meeting notes
    - Mark appointments complete
    - Recommend follow-up tasks

Intern Notes & Follow-up Tracking

- Each student profile inside University CRM should allow:
    - Advisor notes (private)
    - Follow-up reminders
    - Task assignment
        - “review resume”
        - “send internship leads”
        - “Follow-up after interview”
    - Simple status system
        - Open
        - In progress
        - Completed

Basic Workflow Tracking

- University CRM could track:
    - Student seeking internships
    - Student placed
    - Students “at-risk” (low engagement)
    - Students with multiple rejections
- This feeds directly into:
    - KPI dashboard metrics
    - Survey targeting
    - Advisor workload balancing

7. Account

Goal

- Manage institutional presence and access

School Public Profile

- School name
- Logo
- Description
- Career center information
- Public-facing branding for students and employers

User & Role Management

- Add / remove users
- Assign permission tiers:
    - Career center admin
    - Department admin
    - Club admin

Club Accounts

- Clubs can:
    - Upload and manage affiliated job postings
    - Manage their **public club profile**
    - Add club events to the calendar
        - This will only show for students who on their profile say they are in the club
- Clubs cannot:
    - Access school-wide KPIs
    - Modify institutional branding

8. Messages

Goal

- Enable communication between the university and external stakeholders

Messaging System

- Similar to Employer messaging
- User-specific inboxes (no shared inbox)
- Used for:
    - Employer coordination
    - Student outreach
    - Internal collaboration (if enabled)

9. Settings

Goal

- Control security, permissions, and platform configuration

Settings Options

- User permissions and roles
- Branding controls (logo, colors)
- Notification preferences
- Data access rules
- Integration settings (e.g., ePACK)

Job List Ranking Formula SUBJECT TO CHANGE

<u>Budget</u>

RS= (R x 0.45) + ((log(1+E) x 0.15) + (Q x 0.10) + ((log(1+(M/n))) x 0.25) + (F x 0.05)

<u>PPJ</u>

RS= (R x 0.45) + ((log(1+E) x 0.15) + (Q x 0.10) + ((log(1+(M/n))) x 0.25) + (F x 0.05) +0.085

For Organic (free) postings M=0, n is irrelevant

RS= Ranking Score

R= Relevance

- Scaled 1-5

E= Engagement Score

- E= E_i/BS
  - E_i= Individual Account's Engagement Score
    - Calculated by the average of all previous jobs' engagement scores ($\bar{E}_p$)
- BS= Business Size

Small Business= Employee count <500

Medium Business= Employee count 500-999

Large Business= Employee count 1,000+

Q= Quality

- Scaled 1-5

M= Money

F= Freshness

- Scaled 5-1
  - E.g., first 6 days = 5, second 6 days = 4, etc.

Employer Job Post Quality Calculation

Scored 1-5

Items included:

Core Job Information

- Job Title
- Company Name
- Company Logo (optional but recommended)
- Company Description/ "About Us"
- Location (City, State, or Remote/Hybrid designation)
- Employment Type (Full-time, Part-time, Internship, Seasonal, Co-op)
- Compensation (Hourly wage, Salary, or Stipend; must specify if unpaid)
- Benefits
- Start Date

- End Date
- Job Category / Department

Job Description

- Job Overview
- Key Responsibilities / Duties
- Required Qualifications / Skills
- Preferred Qualifications / Skills
- Learning Objectives / Outcomes (for internships)
- Work Schedule / Expected Hours

Candidate Information

- Eligible Majors / Fields of Study
- Year in School or Education Level Required
- Required Certifications / Licenses
- Work Authorization Requirements
- Technical Skills / Tools Required

Application Details

- Required Documents (Resume, Cover Letter, Portfolio, Transcript, etc.)
- Recruiter or Contact Person (Name, Title, Email)
- Company Website or Careers Page

Total= 25/25
Each= 0.2

Search Relevance Allocation

Keyword & Title Match

- Job title includes or closely matches the search keywords
- Core keywords appear naturally in the job description or responsibilities
- Required skills overlap with candidate or search query skills
- Industry or functional category aligns with the user's intent
- Employment type (full-time, part-time) matches the filter

Location & Availability Match

- City or region matches the user's search location or within acceptable radius
- Remote or hybrid options align with the search filter
- Start and end dates fit the candidate's desired timeframe
- Work schedule matches user filters (full-time, part-time)
- Time zone is compatible for remote roles

Candidate Fit

- Education level requirement aligns with the candidate's background

- Major or field of study matches the eligible fields listed
- Experience or seniority level fits the candidate's current stage
- Required or preferred skills overlap with the candidate's top skills
- Certifications or licenses match the candidate's qualifications

Job Description Semantic Alignment

- Responsibilities and duties semantically align with user query or profile
- Tools and software listed match candidate or search keywords
- Learning objectives or development opportunities align with candidate interests (for internships)
- Industry or occupational category matches standard taxonomies (e.g., O*NET)
- Language requirements align with candidate capabilities

Engagement & Recency

- Click-through rate (CTR) indicates strong relevance to jobseekers
- Application conversion rate is high relative to impressions
- Save or share rate reflects user interest and fit
- Posting age is recent, with higher scores for newly posted jobs
- Historical posting performance for similar roles indicates high match quality

(Each input = 0.2 points; total possible = 5.0 maximum)